

available to them. If you want to learn where distinct sounds are coming from, try sweeping through a source sound with an equalisation.

Compression

If you do compression correctly, your sound will be able to maintain a consistent dynamic range while still having sufficient headroom to discriminate between quiet and loud passages. This will allow it to sit comfortably in its own space within the mix.

Compressors function through the use of ratios, thresholds, and output gains at their most fundamental level. The amount of compression that is applied is determined by the ratio, and a high ratio will lead the compressor to behave as a limiter, which may result in an artificial sound. You are able to modify the level of the final output by adjusting the threshold, which determines when the compressor begins to operate. The output gain then makes up for any amplitude that is lost.

Compressors are also controlled by attack and release times, which allow you to adjust the amount of time spent under compression. The rate, which is often expressed in milliseconds, varies depending on the origin of the sound. A sound source that produces sluggish transients will benefit from longer attack and release periods, whereas a sound source that produces fast transients will benefit from faster rates.

Automation

Do not begin the automation process for audio editing too soon; if you do, you will waste a lot of time rewriting and rebalancing the automation later on. This is the most important piece of advice regarding automation in audio editing. It is extremely beneficial to have faith in the mixes, levels, and balances that you have created. Automation is the finishing touch that commits the dynamic flourishes you have chosen and binds together all of the pieces that make up the project.

The following are the standard automation modes:

- Read – plays back existing automation
- Write – writes new automation along with the movement of the play head
- Latch – latches the automated parameter to its last position
- Touch – only write automation when the parameter is changed

Finishing Up

If you are just starting out, it will take some time and a lot of trial and error